

HMD Fusion

Clever add-ons, but core features need work

The HMD Fusion aims to make a splash in the smartphone market with a blend of features and affordability. Priced at Rs 17,999, this smartphone sports a unique design and is powered by the Snapdragon 4 Gen 2 processor. However, after using it for about two weeks, I can say that this phone falls short of expectations in several key areas.

This review will delve deeper into the HMD Fusion phone's strengths and weaknesses, examining its performance, camera capabilities, battery life, and overall value proposition. Keep reading to know if you should buy this phone.

BUILD & DESIGN

The HMD Fusion phone boasts a sleek, retro-inspired aesthetic that stands out in the crowded budget smartphone market. While the back construction feels plasticky, the overall design is visually appealing, and the rear panel sets it apart from other smartphones in its price range.

One notable aspect of the HMD Fusion is its focus on repairability. The phone is designed with a modular approach, making it easier to replace components like the battery or display. This design choice aligns with the growing trend of sustainable electronics. Users who prefer to avoid costly repairs will appreciate this thoughtful addition.

The HMD Fusion also attempts to stand out with its "Smart Outfits," a unique selling point of the brand. These interchangeable covers not only change the phone's appearance but also add functionality.

Among the available Smart Outfits, the Flashy Outfit includes a built-in light that enhances photography. This



feature is particularly beneficial for users who frequently capture photos in low-light conditions. However, while the concept is innovative, the actual performance of the ring light cannot meet professional photography standards.

The Gaming Outfit aims to enhance the mobile gaming experience by adding physical buttons and ergonomic grips. This accessory is designed to provide tactile feedback and improved control during gameplay. However, the implementation may not fully satisfy dedicated gamers, as the responsiveness and comfort of the buttons could be improved.

DISPLAY

The HMD Fusion comes with a 6.56-inch HD+ display that aims to strike a balance between size and clarity. The screen offers decent colour reproduction, with vibrant hues and sharp text that

make it suitable for everyday tasks like browsing and streaming videos. However, the refresh rate is capped at 90Hz, which feels underwhelming compared to the higher refresh rates now common in this price range.

One major drawback of the display is its brightness, especially outdoors. Under direct sunlight, the screen struggles to remain legible, even at maximum brightness levels. In my testing using a Lux Meter, the display showcased a peak brightness of just 403 nits. This can be frustrating for users who frequently use their phones on the go.

While the display performs adequately indoors, the lack of sufficient brightness outdoors is a noticeable limitation that detracts from the overall user experience.

PERFORMANCE

The HMD Fusion is powered by the Snapdragon 4 Gen 2, which is sufficient for handling day-to-day tasks like browsing, social media, and light multitasking. Paired with 8GB of RAM and 256GB of expandable storage, the phone provides enough headroom for casual users. However, when compared to competitors in the same price range, the HMD Fusion falls short in terms of raw performance.

In my testing, the HMD Fusion scored 4,40,793 points on AnTuTu, alongside 921 points in the Geekbench single-core test and 2,229 points in the multi-core test. While these numbers are respectable, they fall short of the benchmark scores achieved by similarly priced devices.

Overall, the HMD Fusion's performance is adequate for casual users but might not satisfy those looking for a powerhouse device in this segment. It handles basic operations with ease but struggles to keep up with the competition.

CAMERA

The HMD Fusion is equipped with a 108-megapixel rear camera accompanied by a 2-megapixel depth sensor, aiming to deliver high-resolution photography in a budget-friendly package. In well-lit conditions, the camera produces passable